



Harmonic Balance Finite Element Analysis of Third Order Intermodulation Products in Ferrite Devices

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Outline

- ❖ Motivation
- ❖ Formulation
 - ❖ Harmonic Balance Finite Elements for nonlinear microwave devices
- ❖ Numerical experiment
 - ❖ H -plane nonlinear analysis of rectangular waveguide ferrite circulator
- ❖ Conclusions



MOTIVATION: THE PROBLEM

- ❖ When high power densities are involved within microwave devices, materials exhibit a significant nonlinear behavior:

$$\mathbf{D} = [\bar{\bar{\epsilon}}(\mathbf{E}, \mathbf{H})]\mathbf{E}$$

$$\mathbf{B} = [\bar{\bar{\mu}}(\mathbf{E}, \mathbf{H})]\mathbf{H}$$

- ❖ If steady state fields are aimed at for a finite set of frequencies, a frequency domain analysis might be preferable to a time domain analysis
- ❖ Frequency domain methods for solving nonlinear PDEs require an iterative solution and the inclusion of higher order harmonics to improve accuracy



MOTIVATION: PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

Harmonic Balance Finite Elements:

- ❖ A multiharmonic finite elements formulation, the Harmonic Balance Finite Elements (HBFE), allows for the inclusion of higher order harmonics which are coupled by means of material characteristics
- ❖ The HBFE approach allows for passive intermodulation analysis (3rd order intermodulation products)

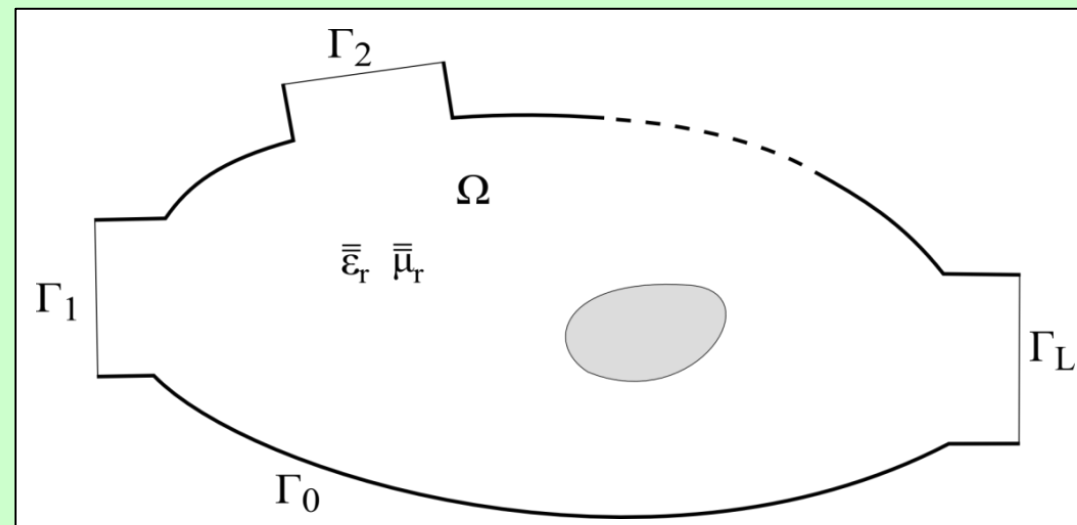
FORMULATION: CONVENTIONAL FINITE ELEMENTS (SINGLE HARMONIC)

❖ We wish to solve the vector Helmholtz equation

$$\nabla \times \left(\overset{=-1}{\mu_r}(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \nabla \times \mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) \right) - k_0^2 \overset{=}{\varepsilon_r}(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) = 0 \quad \text{in } \Omega$$

with

- perfect electric conditions on Γ_0
- modal port expansions on Γ_l , $l=1 \dots L$.





FORMULATION: CONVENTIONAL FINITE ELEMENTS (SINGLE HARMONIC)

- ❖ The electric field is expanded in terms of basis functions:

$$\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_j e_j \mathbf{W}_j(\mathbf{r})$$

- ❖ Galerkin projection leads to a linear system of equations:

$$\int_{\Omega} \mathbf{W}_i(\mathbf{r}) \cdot \left(\nabla \times \left(\overset{=-1}{\mu_r}(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \nabla \times \mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) \right) - k_0^2 \overset{=}{\varepsilon_r}(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) \right) d\Omega = 0$$



$$[a_{mn}][E_n] = [b_m]$$



FORMULATION: HARMONIC BALANCE FE (MULTIPLE HARMONICS)

- ❖ The electric field is expressed as a sum of harmonic functions:

$$\hat{\mathbf{E}}(\mathbf{r}, t) = \sum_{p=1}^P \left(\mathbf{E}_p^{(s)}(\mathbf{r}) \sin(\omega_p t) + \mathbf{E}_p^{(c)}(\mathbf{r}) \cos(\omega_p t) \right)$$

where

$$\begin{cases} \mathbf{E}_p^{(s)}(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_j e_{j,p}^{(s)} \mathbf{W}_j(\mathbf{r}) \\ \mathbf{E}_p^{(c)}(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_j e_{j,p}^{(c)} \mathbf{W}_j(\mathbf{r}) \end{cases}$$

S. Yamada, K. Bessho, and J. Lu, “Harmonic balance finite element method applied to nonlinear AC magnetic analysis,” *IEEE Trans. Magn.*, **MAG-25**, no. 4, pp. 2971–2973, Jul. 1989

D. M. Copeland and U. Langer, “Domain decomposition solvers for nonlinear multiharmonic finite element equations,” *J. Numer. Math.*, vol. 18, no. 3, pp. 157–175, Oct. 2010



FORMULATION: HARMONIC BALANCE FE (MULTIPLE HARMONICS)

- ❖ Materials permittivity or permeability is also expressed in terms of harmonic functions:

$$\overline{\overline{\xi}}_r(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}, t) = \overline{\overline{\xi}}_{r_0} + \sum_{g=1}^G \left(\overline{\overline{\xi}}_{r_g}^{(s)} \sin(\omega_g t) + \overline{\overline{\xi}}_{r_g}^{(c)} \cos(\omega_g t) \right)$$

$$\overline{\overline{\xi}}_r \equiv \left\{ \overline{\overline{\mu}}_r, \overline{\overline{\epsilon}}_r \right\}$$

with

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \overline{\overline{\xi}}_{r_0} = \frac{\omega}{2\pi} \int_0^{\frac{2\pi}{\omega}} \overline{\overline{\xi}}_r(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) dt \\ \overline{\overline{\xi}}_{r_g}^{(s)} = \frac{\omega}{\pi} \int_0^{\frac{2\pi}{\omega}} \overline{\overline{\xi}}_r(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \sin(\omega_g t) dt \\ \overline{\overline{\xi}}_{r_g}^{(c)} = \frac{\omega}{\pi} \int_0^{\frac{2\pi}{\omega}} \overline{\overline{\xi}}_r(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \cos(\omega_g t) dt \end{array} \right.$$



FORMULATION: HARMONIC BALANCE FE (MULTIPLE HARMONICS)

- ❖ With further Galerkin projection of the vector Helmholtz equation with the chosen harmonic functions ($k_0 = \omega_p / c_0$), a large scale HBFE system is obtained

$$[a_{mn}][E_n] = [b_m]$$



$$a_{mn} = \begin{bmatrix} a_{mn}^{(1s1s)} & a_{mn}^{(1s1c)} & \dots & a_{mn}^{(1sPc)} \\ a_{mn}^{(1c1s)} & a_{mn}^{(1c1c)} & \dots & a_{mn}^{(1cPc)} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{mn}^{(Pc1s)} & a_{mn}^{(Pc1c)} & \dots & a_{mn}^{(PcPc)} \end{bmatrix} \quad E_n = \begin{bmatrix} E_n^{(1s)} \\ E_n^{(1c)} \\ \vdots \\ E_n^{(Ps)} \end{bmatrix} \quad b_m = \begin{bmatrix} b_m^{(1s)} \\ b_m^{(1c)} \\ \vdots \\ b_m^{(Pc)} \end{bmatrix}$$



FORMULATION: HARMONIC BALANCE FE (MULTIPLE HARMONICS)

- ❖ The nonlinear solution is handled via a relaxed iteration, starting from a null solution vector to evaluate material properties

$$[A_{(\gamma[E]^{i-1} + (1-\gamma)[E]^{i-2})}][E]^i = [b_{(\gamma[E]^{i-1} + (1-\gamma)[E]^{i-2})}], \quad i \geq 2, \gamma \in (0,1]$$

- ❖ The convergence criterion is chosen on the basis of consecutive solutions:

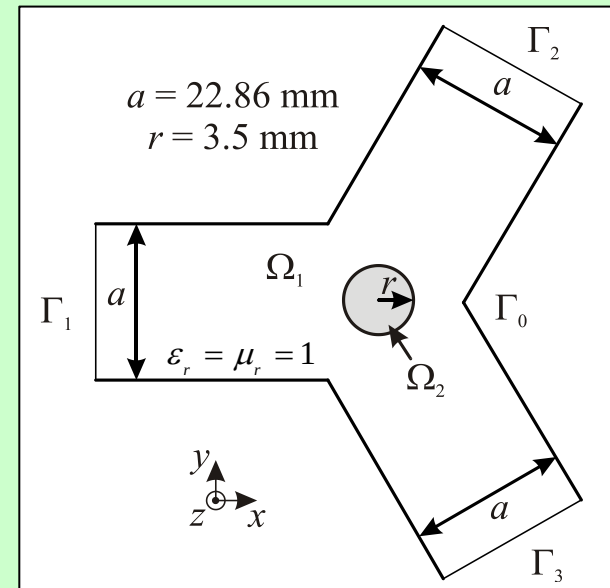
$$\frac{\|[E]^i - [E]^{i-1}\|}{\|[E]^i\|} \leq \tau$$

NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: LINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

❖ For H -plane uniformity

$$\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) = E_z \hat{\mathbf{z}} = \sum_{n=1}^N E_n \phi_n \hat{\mathbf{z}}$$

Thus, vector formulation can be treated as scalar:



$$\int_{\Omega} \mathbf{W}_i(\mathbf{r}) \cdot \left(\nabla \times \left(\overset{=-1}{\mu_r}(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \nabla \times \mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) \right) - k_0^2 \overset{=}{\varepsilon_r}(\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}), \mathbf{r}) \mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}) \right) d\Omega = 0$$

$\Downarrow$

$$\int_{\Omega} \nabla_t \phi_m \cdot \overset{=-1}{\mu_r} \nabla_t E_z d\Omega - k_0^2 \varepsilon_r \int_{\Omega} \phi_m \cdot E_z d\Omega - \sum_{k=1}^3 \int_{\Gamma_k} \phi_m \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial n^{(k)}} d\Gamma = 0$$



NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: LINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

$$\underline{\underline{\mu}}_r(\mathbf{r}) = \begin{bmatrix} \mu_r & j\kappa_r & 0 \\ -j\kappa_r & \mu_r & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \mathbf{r} \in \Omega_2$$

$$\mu_r = 1 + \frac{\omega_0 \omega_m}{\omega_0^2 - \omega^2}$$

$$\kappa_r = \frac{\omega \omega_m}{\omega_0^2 - \omega^2}$$

$$\omega_0 = \gamma H_0, \quad \omega_m = \gamma M_s$$

M. Koshihara and M. Suzuki, "Finite-Element Analysis of H -Plane Waveguide Junction with Arbitrarily Shaped Ferrite Post," *IEEE Trans. Microw. Theory Tech.*, **MTT-34**, no. 1, pp. 103–109, Jan. 1986.



NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: LINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

- ❖ The internal DC magnetic field H_0 , out-of-plane directed, is considered uniform within the TT1-109 ferrite post

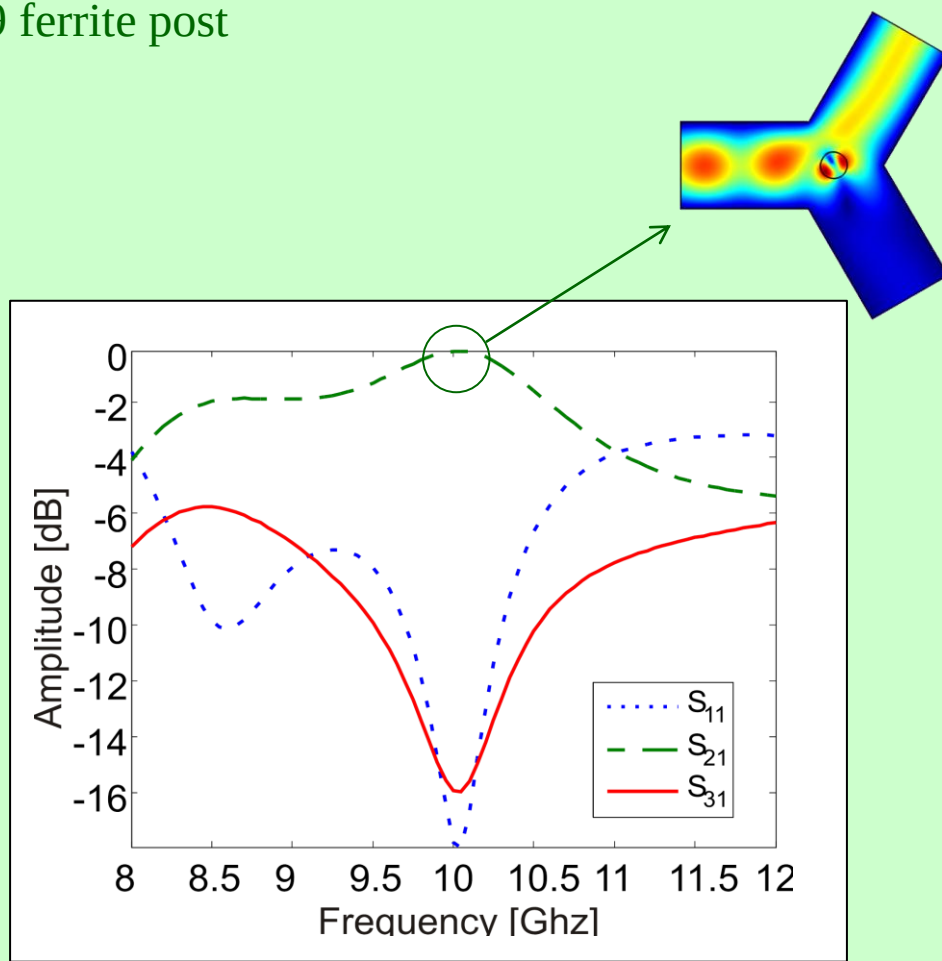
TT1-109 Ferrite Post :

$$\gamma = 1.76 \cdot 10^7 \left[\frac{C}{kg} \right]$$

$$H_o = 200 [G]$$

$$M_s = 1317 [Oe]$$

$$\varepsilon_r(\mathbf{r}) = 11.7, \mathbf{r} \in \Omega_2$$





NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: NONLINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

- ❖ To derive a nonlinear permeability of the ferrite at microwave frequencies, the total magnetic induction and field are given by:

$$\mathbf{H} = H_0 \hat{z} + \mathbf{h}_{AC}, \quad \mathbf{M} = M_s \hat{z} + \mathbf{m}_{AC}$$

- ❖ The macroscopic equation of motion is

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{M}}{\partial t} = \mu_0 \gamma (\mathbf{H} \times \mathbf{M})$$

and expressing equation for each component of the magnetization in frequency domain:

$$\begin{cases} j\omega m_x = \mu_0 \gamma (h_x (M_s + m_z) - m_y (H_i + h_z)) \\ j\omega m_y = \mu_0 \gamma (h_x (M_s + m_z) + m_x (H_i + h_z)) \\ j\omega m_z = \mu_0 \gamma (h_x m_y - m_x h_y) \end{cases}$$



NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: NONLINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

- ❖ By solving the previous system of equations, the following nonlinear relative permeability tensor is obtained:

$$\overline{\overline{\mu_r}}(\mathbf{H}) = \begin{bmatrix} \mu_r(\mathbf{H}) & j\kappa_r(\mathbf{H}) & 0 \\ -j\kappa_r(\mathbf{H}) & \mu_r(\mathbf{H}) & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\mu_r = 1 + \frac{\omega_0 \omega_m}{\omega_0^2 + (\gamma h_x)^2 + (\gamma h_y)^2 - \omega^2} \approx \overline{\mu_r} + \alpha(h_x^2 + h_y^2)$$

$$\kappa_r = \frac{\omega \omega_m}{\omega_0^2 + (\gamma h_x)^2 + (\gamma h_y)^2 - \omega^2} \approx \overline{\kappa_r} + \alpha(h_x^2 + h_y^2)$$



NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: NONLINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

- ❖ Two signals at ω_1 and ω_2 impinging on the device are considered. The out-of-plane electric field is hence expressed in terms of harmonic functions as

$$\begin{aligned}\hat{E}_z(\mathbf{r}) = & E_{z_1}^{(s)} \sin(\omega_1 t) + E_{z_2}^{(s)} \sin(\omega_2 t) + E_{z_3}^{(s)} \sin((2\omega_1 - \omega_2)t) + E_{z_4}^{(s)} \sin((2\omega_2 - \omega_1)t) + \\ & E_{z_5}^{(s)} \sin((2\omega_1 + \omega_2)t) + E_{z_6}^{(s)} \sin((2\omega_2 + \omega_1)t) + E_{z_7}^{(s)} \sin(3\omega_1 t) + E_{z_8}^{(s)} \sin(3\omega_2 t) + \dots \\ & E_{z_1}^{(c)} \cos(\omega_1 t) + E_{z_2}^{(c)} \cos(\omega_2 t) + E_{z_3}^{(c)} \cos((2\omega_1 - \omega_2)t) + E_{z_4}^{(c)} \cos((2\omega_2 - \omega_1)t) + \\ & E_{z_5}^{(c)} \cos((2\omega_1 + \omega_2)t) + E_{z_6}^{(c)} \cos((2\omega_2 + \omega_1)t) + E_{z_7}^{(c)} \cos(3\omega_1 t) + E_{z_8}^{(c)} \cos(3\omega_2 t) + \dots\end{aligned}$$

and so will be the magnetic in-plane components.



NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: NONLINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

- ❖ Ferrite permeability is also expressed in terms of harmonic functions, with coefficients given by, for example for the diagonal ones of the permeability tensor:

$$\hat{\mu}_r = \mu_{r_0} + \sum_{m+n>0 \text{ even}} \mu_{r_{m,n}^+} \cos(m\omega_1 t + n\omega_2 t) + \mu_{r_{m,n}^-} \cos(m\omega_1 t - n\omega_2 t)$$

with

$$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \mu_{r_0} = \frac{\gcd(\omega_1, \omega_2)}{2\pi} \int_0^{\frac{2\pi}{\gcd(\omega_1, \omega_2)}} \mu_r(\mathbf{H}) dt \\ \mu_{r_{m,n}^{\pm}}^{(s)} = \frac{\gcd(\omega_1, \omega_2)}{\pi} \int_0^{\frac{2\pi}{\gcd(\omega_1, \omega_2)}} \mu_r(\mathbf{H}) \sin(m\omega_1 t \pm n\omega_2 t) dt \\ \mu_{r_{m,n}^{\pm}}^{(c)} = \frac{\gcd(\omega_1, \omega_2)}{\pi} \int_0^{\frac{2\pi}{\gcd(\omega_1, \omega_2)}} \mu_r(\mathbf{H}) \cos(m\omega_1 t \pm n\omega_2 t) dt \end{array} \right.$$

and

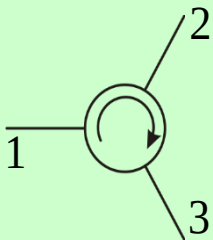
$$\mu_r(\mathbf{H}) = \overline{\mu_r} + \alpha(h_x^2 + h_y^2)$$



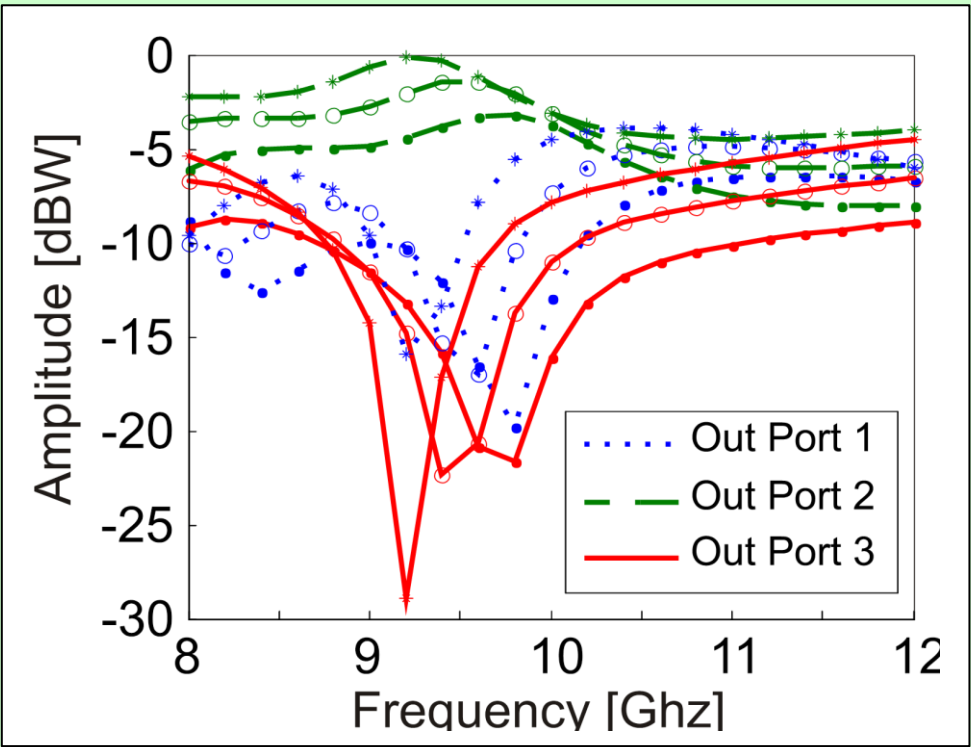
HARMONIC BALANCE FINITE ELEMENT ANALYSIS OF THIRD ORDER INTERMODULATION PRODUCTS IN FERRITE DEVICES

NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: NONLINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR

$P_s @ f_1 \in [8,12] \text{ GHz}$
 $P_i @ f_2 = 7.8 \text{ GHz}$

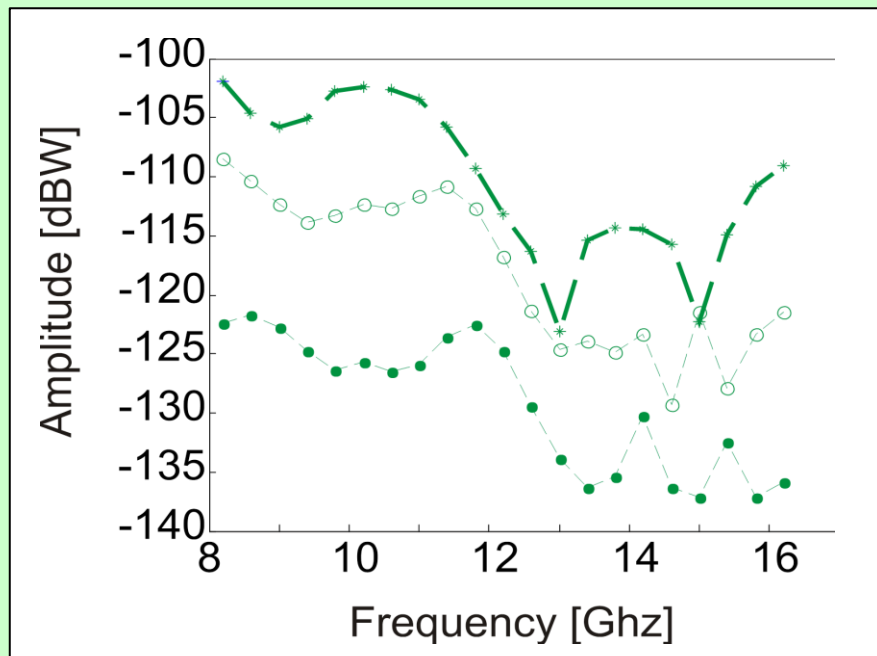
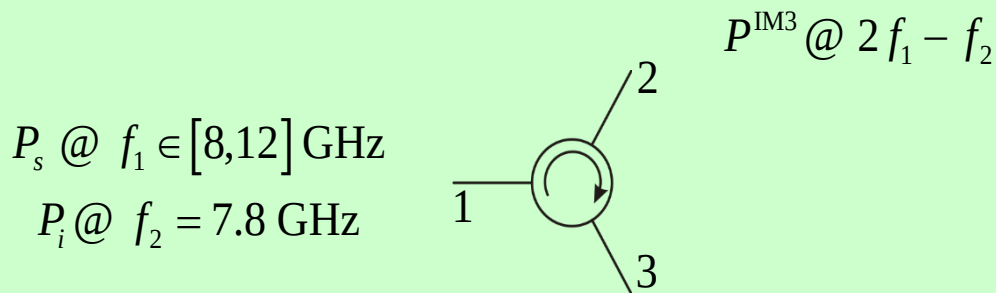


$$\alpha = 2 \cdot 10^{-7} \text{ m}^2/\text{A}^2$$



- $\begin{cases} P_s = 0.5 \text{ W} \\ P_i = 50 \text{ W} \end{cases}$
- $\begin{cases} P_s = 0.75 \text{ W} \\ P_i = 75 \text{ W} \end{cases}$
- * $\begin{cases} P_s = 1 \text{ W} \\ P_i = 100 \text{ W} \end{cases}$

NUMERICAL EXPERIMENT: NONLINEAR MICROWAVE FERRITE CIRCULATOR



- $\begin{cases} P_s = 0.5 \text{ W} \\ P_i = 50 \text{ W} \end{cases}$
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- * $\begin{cases} P_s = 1 \text{ W} \\ P_i = 100 \text{ W} \end{cases}$

H. How, C. Vittoria and R. Schmidt, "Nonlinear intermodulation coupling in ferrite circulator junctions," *IEEE Trans. Microw. Theory Tech.*, MTT-45, no. 3, pp. 245–252, Feb. 1997.



CONCLUSIONS

- ❖ A Harmonic Balance Finite Element technique has been presented for solving the wave equation in presence of nonlinear media
- ❖ Third order intermodulation products within a nonlinear ferrite circulator have been evaluated, in good agreement with the reported literature